

149 Make an erupting volcano

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Volcanoes erupt in various ways. Some ooze lava slowly, but others hurl rocks and molten material sky-high. Make this model volcano and watch your very own Vesuvius erupt.

What you need

- Plastic bottle • Tray
- Water • Measuring cup
- Food coloring • Dishwashing liquid • Sand • Funnel
- Baking soda • Vinegar



1 Use the cup to measure how much water the bottle holds. Put the empty bottle on the tray.



2 Pile moist sand around the bottle, as above. Fill the cup with warm water equal to two-thirds of the bottle. Add two heaping tablespoons of soda and stir.

"Lava" flowing



3 Add a spoonful each of food coloring and dishwashing liquid to the cup. Stir. Use the funnel to pour the cup's contents into the bottle. Add half a cup of vinegar to the measuring cup. Pour it into the bottle and stand back. The eruption is about to take place!

It's best to do this outside!

150 Make a stone float

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Pumice is a rock made from frothy lava. It contains lots of holes that make it lighter than other rocks. Drop a pumice stone in a bowl of water to see it float. It will sink eventually, as water enters the air holes.

Air holes

